

Third Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Tertia Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: the endangered sinner sought, strengthened, and welcomed into joy

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Respice in me, et miserere mei</i> (Ps. 24:16, 18)	Solitude, poverty, mercy	The worshipper enters neither self-sufficient nor hidden: affliction and sin are placed under God's merciful gaze.
Collect	<i>Protector in te sperantium, Deus</i>	Providence and pilgrimage	God's mercy supplies what is neither strong nor holy without him and orders temporal goods toward eternity.
Epistle	1 Pet. 5:6–11	Humility, trust, vigilance	Casting care on God and resisting the devil are one movement of humble, active faith.
Gradual	<i>Iacta cogitatum tuum in Domino</i> (Ps. 54:23, 17, 19)	Entrusted anxiety and deliverance	Before the Gospel, the congregation practices entrusting the anxiety that makes isolation and despair attractive.
Alleluia	<i>Deus iudex iustus, fortis et patiens</i> (Ps. 7:12)	Justice, strength, patience	Divine patience opens the Gospel's mercy without denying judgment.
Gospel	Luke 15:1–10	Sheep, drachma, repentance, joy	Christ answers proud murmuring by revealing the search for sinners and heaven's joy at their repentance.
Offertory	<i>Sperent in te omnes</i> (Ps. 9:11–13)	Trust and the poor man's prayer	The found sinner becomes an offering Church that trusts, seeks, praises, and remembers the afflicted.
Communion	<i>Gaudium est Angelis Dei</i> (Luke 15:10)	Joy over repentance	The antiphon celebrates repentant restoration; Eucharistic joy does not erase the call to conversion or proper reception.
Postcommunion	<i>Sancta tua nos, Domine, sumpta vivificent</i>	Vivification and lasting mercy	The holy things received give life and prepare the purified faithful for everlasting mercy.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Jesus receives publicans and sinners and answers the Pharisees' and scribes' murmuring with a shepherd and a woman who seek until they find; Peter commands humility, the casting of care on God, vigilance, and resistance in faith.
Allegorical	Gregory reads the Shepherd as Christ bearing fallen humanity, and the woman and lamp as divine Wisdom manifested in the flesh to restore the Creator's likeness in man. The Church proclaims and sacramentally serves this saving work.
Moral	Grace takes the initiative, yet the hearer is summoned to repent, humble himself, cast his cares on God, resist the devil, and exchange contempt at another's return for shared joy.
Anagogical	The angels' joy and the Postcommunion's everlasting mercy direct present repentance toward the restored heavenly communion of angels and redeemed humanity.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Shepherd and Sheep	Gregory, <i>Forty Gospel Homilies</i> 34, reads Christ's shoulders as his assumption of human nature and bearing of sin. The image establishes grace's initiative without making the sinner inert: Luke names repentance, while the Epistle commands humility and resistance in faith.
Drachma and Image	Gregory reads the stamped coin as man created in God's image whose likeness is disfigured by sin and restored. Ambrose's exhortation moves from recovered worth to response: the redeemed coin must live at the value bestowed by the King.
Lamp and House	Gregory identifies the lamp with divine Wisdom shining through Christ's humanity and the swept house with conscience disturbed and cleansed. This documented reading is more precise than treating every detail as an unspecified ecclesial symbol.
Lion and Heavenly Joy	Editorial synthesis: Peter's prowling lion isolates and devours; Luke's Shepherd seeks and heaven rejoices. Vigilance therefore guards hope, while mercy prevents vigilance from collapsing into despair.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

Thread	Synthesis
1. Introit	Text/function: Psalm 24 gives the entrance voice of one solitary, poor, afflicted, and conscious of sin. Editorial reading: the Mass begins by making need visible to mercy rather than concealing it in self-reliance.
2. Collect	Text/function: the Church asks her Protector to multiply mercy and guide passage through temporal goods toward eternal ones. Diagnosis/placement: the endangered soul needs both rescue from evil and a rightly ordered pilgrimage.
3. Epistle	Text/function: 1 Peter 5 commands humility, surrendered anxiety, sobriety, vigilance, and firm resistance. Editorial reading: trust is not passivity; care is cast on God so that the Christian can stand and resist in faith.

Thread	Synthesis
4. Gradual	Text/function: <i>Iacta cogitatum tuum in Domino</i> (Ps. 54:23, 17, 19) turns Peter's command into sung prayer. Placement: before the Gospel, the congregation practices entrusting the very anxiety that makes isolation and despair attractive.
5. Alleluia	Text/function: <i>Deus iudex iustus, fortis et patiens</i> (Ps. 7:12) acclaims a just, strong, patient Judge. Editorial reading: divine patience supplies the key for hearing mercy without denying judgment.
6. Gospel	Text/function: Luke 15 discloses the Shepherd's and woman's persistent search and the joy surrounding repentance. Patristic control: Gregory contrasts compassionate true justice with disdainful false justice; Ambrose joins recovered dignity to an active return.
7. Offertory	Text/function: Psalm 9 invites all who know God's name to hope and remembers the prayer of the poor. Placement: the poor sinner now offers not self-justification but trust, praise, and solidarity with other afflicted members.
8. Secret	Text/function: <i>Respice, Domine, munera supplicantis Ecclesiae</i> asks that the Church's gifts be received unto the believers' salvation through perpetual sanctification. Placement: being found becomes ecclesial offering and a continuing work of holiness.
9. Communion	Text/function: Luke 15:10 places angelic joy on the communicant's lips. Diagnosis/placement: the murmuring exposed in the Gospel must yield to the joy of reconciled communion.
10. Postcommunion	Text/function: the Church asks that the received holy things vivify and prepare the purified for everlasting mercy. Final effect: rescue matures into sacramental life ordered to eternity.

Grouped instruction (editorial synthesis). The Mass moves from exposed poverty through mercy-guided humility and vigilant trust into Christ's search, then turns the found sinner toward sanctified offering, repentant Communion, and everlasting mercy. The faithful are neither self-rescuers nor inert objects: they are sought by grace and enabled to repent, resist, offer, receive, and rejoice.

Exegetical Notes

- Luke first says that sinners draw near to hear Jesus; repentance begins under an attractive word of mercy, not under the Pharisees' disdain.
- The Gradual repeats the Epistle's casting of care, so the chant makes the apostolic command an immediate act of prayer.
- The Alleluia's just and patient Judge prevents a false choice between moral seriousness and the joy of recovery.

Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

Witness	Text / source status	Interpretive contribution
St. Gregory the Great, <i>Forty Gospel Homilies</i> 34	Direct quotation: "True justice has compassion, while false justice has disdain."	Controls the reading of the murmurers: discipline must remain inwardly charitable and humble.

Witness	Text / source status	Interpretive contribution
St. Ambrose, <i>Exposition of the Gospel of Luke</i> VII.211–212	Direct quotation: “We are coins. Let us have a price. We are sons. Let us hurry to the Father.”	Keeps divine initiative and human response together: restored dignity summons an active return.
St. Gregory the Great, <i>Forty Gospel Homilies</i> 34	Paraphrase: the incarnate Wisdom lights the lamp, disturbs the house of conscience, and restores the Creator’s likeness in the coin.	Grounds the coin and lamp in an identified reading rather than an unattributed symbolic consensus.

Homiletic Synthesis

Thread	Synthesis
Proposition	Christ’s searching mercy does not abolish repentance and vigilance; it makes the endangered sinner able to return, resist, and enter heaven’s joy.
Movement I – gift	God sees the poor, receives care cast upon him, seeks the lost through the incarnate Son, and makes one sinner’s return a feast for heaven.
Movement II – resistance	Pride hides need, anxiety turns inward, the devil exploits isolation, and false justice resents mercy shown to another.
Movement III – sacramental conversion	At the Offertory the found sinner joins the supplicating Church; the Secret asks continuing sanctification, and Communion gives the repentant heaven’s own song of joy.
Final horizon	Make a truthful act of repentance and trust, resist the isolating lie, welcome another penitent, and live toward everlasting mercy among the rejoicing angels.

Preaching Applications

- Address shame without minimizing sin: Christ seeks precisely so that the sinner may repent and be restored.
- Invite one concrete practice joining grace and response: confession, casting a named anxiety on God, or seeking help against an isolating temptation.
- Warn regular worshippers that disdain for another’s conversion imitates the Gospel’s murmurers rather than heaven’s angels.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Tertia post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus, lines for the Third Sunday after Pentecost. Latin OCR remains to be checked against a printed missal before publication.
- St. Gregory the Great, *Forty Gospel Homilies*, Homily 34, excerpts on Luke 15, [linked working English text](#).
- St. Ambrose, *Exposition of the Gospel of Luke* VII.211–212, [linked working English excerpt](#).

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. Gregory the Great, *Forty Gospel Homilies*, Homily 34: “True justice has compassion, while false justice has disdain.”
- St. Ambrose, *Exposition of the Gospel of Luke* VII.211–212: “We are coins. Let us have a price. We are sons. Let us hurry to the Father.”